

WORKSHEET

Marketing Automation Planning Worksheet

Design the workflow before you build it. This worksheet turns a business process into explicit triggers, qualification rules, actions, branches, handoffs, notifications, human review, and measurement.

This worksheet is intentionally centered on marketing automation planning rather than generic project planning. Complete it before creating a production workflow so the automation has a clear audience, purpose, stop conditions, owner, and success measure.

WORKFLOW CONTROL

Workflow / automation name:

Business owner:

Automation builder:

Version / last revised:

Primary audience / segment:

Planning rule

Every automated action should have a documented reason. Every trigger should have a documented audience. Every branch should have a documented condition. Every human handoff should have an owner and a completion expectation.

1. Define the automation objective

Start with the business outcome, not the workflow editor.

BUSINESS OUTCOME

What business problem is this automation solving?

What should be different after the automation runs?

What is the primary conversion or operational outcome?

What should the automation explicitly NOT do?

AUDIENCE AND ELIGIBILITY

FIELD	YOUR DEFINITION	RULE / EXAMPLE
Target audience		Who should receive the experience?
Exclusions		Existing customers, employees, competitors, suppressed contacts, etc.
Minimum data		What must be known before enrollment?
Lifecycle / stage		Which business stage(s) qualify?
Geography / market		Location, territory, service area, market, language.

2. Map the enrollment trigger

The trigger defines when the automation starts. Be precise enough that another person could build the same condition without guessing.

PRIMARY TRIGGER

TRIGGER TYPE	SELECT / DEFINE	DETAILS TO DOCUMENT
Filter-based	[] Property / list / segment	Exact property, operator, value(s), AND/OR logic.
Event-based	[] Form / CTA / page / event	Exact event, timing, and whether the event is repeatable.
Schedule-based	[] Date / recurring schedule	Date property, recurrence, timezone, timing window.
Webhook / integration	[] External event	Source system, event name, identity matching, failure behavior.
Manual	[] Controlled enrollment	Who may enroll, required review, and audit trail.

Exact enrollment condition

Write the rule in plain language:

Write the same rule as structured logic (AND / OR):

RE-ENROLLMENT AND STOP CONDITIONS

- ☐ **Re-enrollment rule**
Should a record ever enter again? What event or state change makes re-entry appropriate?
- ☐ **Unenrollment rule**
What condition should immediately stop the automation?
- ☐ **Suppression rule**
Who should never enter, or who should be excluded while another campaign/process is active?
- ☐ **Goal / success stop**
What outcome means the automation no longer needs to continue?

3. Build the action sequence

Translate the business process into an ordered sequence. Include delays, actions, decision points, and the information each step depends on.

STEP	TRIGGER / CONDITION	ACTION	TIMING	OWNER / SYSTEM
1	_____	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____	_____
4	_____	_____	_____	_____
5	_____	_____	_____	_____
6	_____	_____	_____	_____
7	_____	_____	_____	_____
8	_____	_____	_____	_____

DELAY AND TIMING RULES

TIMING DECISION	YOUR RULE	WHY
Delay after trigger	_____	_____
Business hours / timezone	_____	_____
Wait for data	_____	_____
Wait for human action	_____	_____
Maximum time in automation	_____	_____

4. Plan qualification, branches, and routing

A useful automation does more than send messages. It identifies whether the record is ready for the next step and routes the record accordingly.

QUALIFICATION RULES

CRITERION	QUALIFIED	NOT YET / EXCLUDE	DATA SOURCE
Fit / firmographic	_____	_____	_____
Behavior / intent	_____	_____	_____
Engagement	_____	_____	_____
Need / service interest	_____	_____	_____
Readiness / timing	_____	_____	_____

BRANCHING PLAN

BRANCH	CONDITION	PATH / ACTION	EXIT
A	_____	_____	_____
B	_____	_____	_____
C	_____	_____	_____
D	_____	_____	_____

HANDOFF TO PEOPLE

- ☐ **Sales handoff**
What exact condition creates a sales-ready handoff? Who owns it? What information must be included?
- ☐ **Marketing review**
When should a person review the record before more automation occurs?
- ☐ **Service / success handoff**
What event moves the record into onboarding, support, or retention?
- ☐ **No-response path**
What happens when the contact never responds or never reaches the target state?

5. Plan messages, content, and contact policy

Write the communication strategy before drafting individual emails or tasks.

MESSAGE MAP

MESSAGE	PURPOSE	AUDIENCE STATE	CTA / NEXT STEP	CONTENT OWNER
1	_____	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____	_____
4	_____	_____	_____	_____
5	_____	_____	_____	_____

CONSENT, SUPPRESSION, AND CONTACT POLICY

- ☐ **Consent basis**
What permission or lawful basis governs the communication? What system/property records that state?
- ☐ **Unsubscribe / preference handling**
How are opt-outs, communication preferences, and channel restrictions respected?
- ☐ **Suppression audiences**
Which active campaigns, customers, employees, or other audiences must be excluded?
- ☐ **Frequency control**
What is the maximum contact frequency across this automation and other campaigns?
- ☐ **Sensitive content**
What information should never be inserted automatically into a message?

Content QA notes

Tone / voice requirements:

Personalization fields allowed:

6. Define measurement, testing, and launch criteria

A workflow is not finished when the messages are built. Define how performance and correctness will be proven.

SUCCESS MEASURES

MEASURE	DEFINITION	TARGET / BASELINE	REPORT
Primary outcome	_____	_____	_____
Conversion rate	_____	_____	_____
Engagement	_____	_____	_____
Speed / SLA	_____	_____	_____
Exception rate	_____	_____	_____

TEST CASES

CASE	SETUP	EXPECTED RESULT	PASS
New qualified record	_____	_____	[]
Existing record meeting criteria	_____	_____	[]
Excluded / suppressed record	_____	_____	[]
Missing required data	_____	_____	[]
Branch A	_____	_____	[]
Branch B	_____	_____	[]
Human handoff	_____	_____	[]
Re-enrollment / repeat event	_____	_____	[]
Integration failure	_____	_____	[]

LAUNCH GATE

- ☐ **Owner sign-off**
Business owner approves audience, logic, messaging, routing, and success criteria.
- ☐ **QA sign-off**
Representative records pass all critical test cases, including exclusions and edge cases.
- ☐ **Data readiness**
Required fields, source data, associations, and attribution fields are available and reliable.
- ☐ **Monitoring ready**
A report, alert, or review process exists for errors, volume spikes, stalled records, and outcome performance.

7. One-page automation blueprint

Use this page as the build handoff. A marketer, RevOps owner, or developer should be able to build the automation from this blueprint without reconstructing the strategy.

AUTOMATION BLUEPRINT	
ELEMENT	FINAL DEFINITION
Objective	
Audience	
Primary trigger	
Enrollment filters	
Re-enrollment	
Suppression / unenrollment	
Primary actions	
Branches	
Qualification rule	
Human handoff	
Primary success metric	
Owner + review cadence	

BUILD NOTES / EXCEPTIONS

Technical or integration dependencies:

Known limitations / exceptions:

Next review date:

HubSpot currently supports workflow enrollment using filter-based, event-based, scheduled, and webhook-driven triggers, with settings for re-enrollment and unenrollment. Use the current HubSpot interface and documentation to confirm plan-specific availability before implementation. Sources: HubSpot Knowledge Base, current workflow documentation (September 2026).